

Contact

Riyadh
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Top Skills

Construction Management
Data Analysis
Web Development

Languages

Arabic (Native or Bilingual)
English (Full Professional)
German (Elementary)

Certifications

postgraduate of business
administration
Project Management Professional
(PMP)®
2023 Distinguished Expert

Ashraf Ibrahim El Desoky (PMP)

Projects Director | PMP® | PMO Leader | Telecommunications & Infrastructure Expert | FTTH, OSP, ISP & 5G Rollout | Strategic Program Management | MBA Candidate | 25+ Years of Global Experience

Riyadh, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Summary

With over 25 years of international experience in Telecommunications, Digital Infrastructure, and Large-Scale Capital Projects, I help organizations successfully deliver complex programs that create measurable business value. As a PMP®-certified Projects Director and PMO leader, I specialize in transforming strategy into execution by leading multidisciplinary teams, establishing governance frameworks, optimizing project portfolios, and delivering complex infrastructure programs safely, on schedule, and within budget. Throughout my career, I have successfully directed multi-million-dollar projects across FTTH/FTTx, OSP, ISP, 5G network deployment, Fiber Optic Infrastructure, and Low Current Systems. My experience spans the complete project lifecycle—from business planning, bid management, and contract administration through execution, risk management, quality assurance, commercial control, and successful project closeout. I have extensive experience working with international consultants, telecom operators, contractors, and executive stakeholders, enabling effective collaboration across multicultural environments while driving operational excellence and continuous improvement.

Core Competencies

- Project & Program Management (PMP®)
- PMO Leadership & Governance
- Strategic Portfolio Management
- Project Controls & Performance Reporting
- Risk, Issue & Change Management
- Contract & Commercial Management
- Stakeholder & Executive Management
- FTTH / FTTx / OSP / ISP Deployment
- 5G Network Rollout Programs
- CAPEX / OPEX Planning & Cost Control
- Vendor & Contractor Management
- Resource Planning & Optimization
- Quality Management & Compliance
- Fiber Optic Infrastructure Delivery
- Low Current Systems (BMS, CCTV, ELV)

I am currently pursuing an MBA at Edinburgh Business School to further strengthen my

strategic leadership, financial management, and organizational transformation capabilities. I am passionate about leading high-performing teams, delivering complex infrastructure programs, and enabling organizations to achieve sustainable growth through disciplined project management, innovation, and operational excellence.

Experience

AlSharq Office Company for Contracting , Trading & Maintenance
Telecommunication Engineer / Project Control Mgr.

August 2024 - Present (2 years)

Saudi Arabia

Lead the planning and execution of key electrical and telecommunication projects, ensuring alignment with client requirements and contract specifications.

Key Responsibilities:

- Collaborate directly with the Budget and Planning Department Manager to develop comprehensive project budgets, forecasts, and financial controls.
- Provide detailed progress updates and risk assessments to the Section Manager of Electric and Telecommunication Projects.
- Manage project resources, including engineering teams and subcontractors, to deliver projects on schedule and with a focus on quality and safety.
- Serve as the primary technical point of contact for clients, resolving issues and managing expectations throughout the project lifecycle.
- Implement project management best practices to optimize operational efficiency and project outcomes.

Egyptian Company for General Contracting and Supplies
Projects Director - Telecommunications Sector

September 2023 - June 2024 (10 months)

Cairo, Egypt

- Leading and managing telecommunications projects from inception to completion, ensuring timely and successful project delivery.
- Overseeing all phases of the project lifecycle, including initiation, planning, execution, monitoring, and closure.
- Collaborating with cross-functional teams, including engineers, technicians, vendors, and stakeholders, to ensure effective project execution.

- Developing comprehensive project plans, defining scope, objectives, timelines, resource allocation, and budget management.
- Monitoring project progress, tracking milestones, and providing regular status updates to stakeholders.
- Identifying, assessing, and managing project risks and issues, implementing mitigation strategies to minimize project disruptions.
- Ensuring compliance with project management methodologies, industry standards, and regulatory requirements in the telecommunications sector.
- Managing project budgets, expenses, and resources effectively to optimize project performance and profitability.

Challenges:

- Managing multiple complex telecommunications projects simultaneously, each with unique technical requirements, stakeholder expectations, and regulatory considerations.
- Navigating the rapidly evolving technological landscape in the telecommunications industry, ensuring project plans and execution align with the latest advancements and industry best practices.
- Coordinating with various government agencies and regulatory bodies to obtain necessary approvals, licenses, and permits for telecommunications projects, ensuring compliance with local and national regulations.
- Mitigating the impact of supply chain disruptions, resource constraints, or unforeseen technical challenges on project timelines and budgets, while maintaining high-quality project deliverables.
- Fostering effective collaboration and communication among diverse teams, including internal staff, external vendors, and stakeholders with varying technical backgrounds and cultural perspectives.

Sabbour Consulting

Lead Consultant Project Manager - Light Current Systems

November 2021 - September 2023 (1 year 11 months)

Egypt

Project: The Egyptian International Olympic Games City

Key Responsibilities:

- Strategic leadership and oversight for the implementation of light current systems (Fire Alarm, Access Control, CCTV, Gate Barrier, Time Attendance, Telephone, Data Communication Network, and BMS).
- Conducted comprehensive site visits to assess progress, ensuring adherence to project plans, timelines, and quality standards.

- Coordinated and managed teams of contractors, engineers, and stakeholders to ensure successful project completion.
- Provided technical guidance and support during implementation and commissioning phases, resolving complex challenges.
- Played a pivotal role in the integration of light current systems for seamless operations across the project.
- Collaborated with the Technical Office to provide solutions and support for efficient project execution.
- Prepared detailed technical reports, recommendations for system improvements, and comprehensive project documentation.

Sabbour Consulting

Lead Consultant project manager.

January 2020 - January 2021 (1 year 1 month)

Egypt

Project: OSP project installation of Fiber optic network in the New Administrative Capital

Key Responsibilities:

- Strategic guidance and oversight for the planning, execution, and monitoring of the fiber optic network implementation project.
- Expertise in FTTH projects, encompassing fiber optic cable installation, splicing, and testing procedures.
- Conducted inspections of materials and approved those meeting acceptance criteria, ensuring compliance with project specifications.
- Collaborated with the surveying engineer to oversee and validate surveying work, ensuring accurate data collection and analysis.
- Reviewed and approved shop drawings, ensuring alignment with project requirements and efficient execution.
- Maintained meticulous document archiving and control processes, ensuring accurate and accessible project records.
- Attended coordination meetings with consulting companies, facilitating communication and collaboration with other work streams on-site.
- Successfully supervised the network implementation, connecting ministries to the data center and main exchange.

Benya Systems

Senior Site Manager

December 2017 - August 2020 (2 years 9 months)

Egypt

Project: Egypt National Railways Modernization Project (ENRMP)

Responsibilities:

- Elevated to the highest level of leadership within the project, overseeing all aspects of implementation and testing of fiber optic networks for the Egypt National Railways Modernization Project.
- Demonstrated expertise in end-to-end project management, ensuring seamless coordination of site surveys, civil works, cabling, and equipment installation.
- Spearheaded the preparation of sites for underground and aerial fiber deployment, navigating complex logistical challenges and ensuring compliance with regulatory standards.
- Led a team in executing outdoor cable laying operations, meticulously managing bending radius and drum handling to maintain cable integrity.
- Provided strategic technical guidance on splicing, cable storage, and organizational structures within joint manholes, optimizing network efficiency and reliability.
- Overseeing termination and testing of fiber optic cables, ensuring adherence to industry standards and project specifications.
- Addressing unique challenges associated with fiber optic infrastructure for railway systems, including vibration, electromagnetic interference, and environmental factors.
- Ensuring adherence to safety protocols and quality control measures along railway tracks and within railway facilities.

Norconsult Telematics Ltd

Senior Project Control Engineer Fixed Network Implementation

December 2007 - December 2017 (10 years 1 month)

Saudi Arabia

Responsibilities:

- Provided expert oversight and management of project control activities for multiple large-scale telecommunications projects undertaken by Saudi Telecom Company (STC) across Saudi Arabia.
- Supervised the implementation of robust project control systems and processes, ensuring adherence to industry best practices, project management methodologies, and STC's internal standards.
- Conducted comprehensive risk assessments, developed risk mitigation strategies, and implemented proactive measures to address potential project risks and issues.

- Monitored project progress, tracked key performance indicators, and prepared detailed reports and presentations for senior management and stakeholders.
- Collaborated closely with project managers, engineers, and cross-functional teams to identify and resolve project-related challenges, ensuring seamless project execution.

Challenges:

- Managing project control activities for multiple concurrent and complex telecommunications projects, each with unique technical requirements, stakeholder expectations, and regulatory considerations.
- Navigating the intricate regulatory landscape and ensuring compliance with local and international regulations, industry standards, and STC's internal policies across diverse project portfolios.
- Developing and implementing project control systems and processes that could effectively accommodate the diverse nature of STC's project portfolio, ranging from infrastructure deployment to network upgrades and maintenance.
- Fostering effective collaboration and communication among cross-functional teams, including project managers, engineers, contractors, and stakeholders, to ensure seamless project execution and decision-making.
- Adapting project control strategies and methodologies to accommodate evolving market conditions, technological advancements, and organizational priorities, while minimizing disruptions to ongoing projects.

MILLENSYS Healthcare Technology

Senior Project Program Manager

November 2006 - December 2007 (1 year 2 months)

Egypt

Key Projects:

- Tanta University Faculty of Medicine Hospital
- Women's Health Care Project: Early Detection of Breast Cancer in Egypt

Responsibilities:

- Provided strategic leadership and oversight in managing complex projects from inception through design, construction, and successful implementation.
- Developed comprehensive project plans, defining scope, objectives, timelines, resource allocation, and budget management.

- Led cross-functional project teams, coordinating the efforts of diverse stakeholders, including contractors, engineers, and vendors, to ensure seamless execution and adherence to project timelines.
- Conducted regular project progress reviews, analyzing performance metrics, budgets, and timelines, and implementing corrective actions as necessary to maintain project schedules and cost-effectiveness.
- Optimized operational methods and accounting procedures to enhance project efficiency, cost control, and financial reporting accuracy.
- Leveraged effective negotiation and communication skills to manage relationships with contractors, ensuring their performance aligned with project objectives and quality standards.
- Identified and mitigated potential project risks, implementing proactive strategies to address challenges and minimize disruptions to project delivery.
- Prepared and presented comprehensive project reports and updates to senior management and clients, ensuring transparency and effective communication regarding project progress and outcomes.

Key Achievements:

- Successfully managed the construction and implementation of the Tanta University Faculty of Medicine Hospital project, delivering a state-of-the-art healthcare facility within budget and timeline constraints.
- Played a pivotal role in the Women's Health Care Project for the Early Detection of Breast Cancer in Egypt, contributing to the development of a nationwide initiative to improve healthcare access and outcomes for women.

Masreya for Information Technology & Telecommunications (MITT)

Senior Project Site Engineer

December 2005 - December 2006 (1 year 1 month)

Sudan

Project: Fiber Optical Ring around Khartoum Area

Responsibilities:

- Provided on-site technical leadership and supervision during the implementation of a large-scale fiber optic network installation project, encompassing the deployment of a fiber optical ring around the Khartoum area.
- Conducted rigorous inspections and oversight of Horizontal Directional Drilling (HDD) operations, ensuring adherence to industry standards, project specifications, and safety protocols.

- Supervised and coordinated the activities of field crews, contractors, and subcontractors involved in the installation of the fiber optic network, fostering collaboration and ensuring seamless execution.
- Performed comprehensive acceptance testing on installed fiber optic cables, including Optical Time Domain Reflectometer (OTDR) tests, insertion loss measurements, and continuity checks, to validate compliance with project specifications and quality standards.
- Leveraged expertise in fiber optic technologies to implement high-performance fiber optic links between major exchange centers across regions, enabling reliable and high-speed data transmission.
- Maintained meticulous documentation and record-keeping, ensuring accurate project reporting and compliance with regulatory requirements.
- Collaborated with project managers, engineers, and stakeholders to resolve on-site challenges, mitigate risks, and implement contingency plans as necessary to maintain project timelines and quality standards.

Challenges:

- Managing a complex fiber optic network installation project across a large geographical area, with diverse terrain and environmental conditions.
- Coordinating the efforts of multiple field crews, contractors, and subcontractors, ensuring effective communication, collaboration, and adherence to project specifications and safety protocols.

Siemens

Project Controller - OSP Network Implementation

November 2000 - November 2004 (4 years 1 month)

Egypt

Key Projects:

- Shoubra Exchange Network Expansion
- Assuit Exchanges Network Expansion

Responsibilities:

- Assumed a pivotal role in the implementation of critical OSP (Outside Plant) network projects, responsible for managing project resources, monitoring budgets, preparing reports, and ensuring alignment with project plans.
- Maintained open and effective communication channels with customers, presenting regular updates on project status, progress, and any technical challenges encountered.

- Reported comprehensively to project managers on various aspects, including budget utilization, progress tracking, and technical issues, facilitating informed decision-making and proactive risk mitigation.
- Developed and fostered courteous and effective working relationships with cross-functional teams, contractors, and stakeholders, promoting collaboration and seamless project execution.
- Leveraged proficiency in Microsoft Office tools, including Word and Excel, to create professional documents, presentations, and spreadsheets for project reporting and communication.
- Participated in the implementation of large-scale network expansion projects, including the Shoubra Exchange Network Expansion and the Assuit Exchanges Network Expansion in Upper Egypt, contributing to the successful deployment of terrestrial network infrastructure across multiple cities.
- Responsible for managing raw materials and inventory, overseeing project budgets, preparing comprehensive project reports, and closely monitoring project progress to ensure alignment with established plans and timelines.

Key Achievements:

- Contributed to the successful implementation of the Shoubra Exchange Network Expansion project, enabling the deployment of expanded network infrastructure to support growing demand in the region.

Sheraton Hotels & Resorts

Senior Maintenance Shift Engineer

January 1999 - January 2000 (1 year 1 month)

Egypt

Responsibilities:

- Provided technical leadership and supervision during assigned maintenance shifts, ensuring the seamless operation and upkeep of the hotel's various systems, including HVAC, electrical, plumbing, and mechanical equipment.
- Conducted regular inspections and preventive maintenance activities on critical hotel infrastructure, identifying and addressing potential issues before they escalated into system failures or guest disruptions.
- Responded promptly to maintenance requests and service calls, coordinating with cross-functional teams, such as housekeeping, front desk, and engineering, to resolve issues efficiently and minimize guest inconvenience.
- Trained and mentored junior maintenance staff, ensuring adherence to safety protocols, quality standards, and best practices in hotel maintenance operations.

- Maintained detailed records of maintenance activities, equipment repairs, and system performance, facilitating effective inventory management and informed decision-making for future upgrades or replacements.
- Collaborated with external vendors and service providers, coordinating maintenance activities, negotiating contracts, and ensuring compliance with relevant regulations and industry standards.
- Developed and implemented preventive maintenance schedules and standard operating procedures (SOPs) to optimize system performance, reduce downtime, and extend the lifespan of hotel equipment and infrastructure.

Challenges:

- Managing a diverse range of maintenance tasks and systems across a large hotel property, ensuring seamless operations and guest satisfaction while working within budget constraints and resource limitations.
- Coordinating maintenance activities with ongoing hotel operations, minimizing disruptions to guests, and maintaining a high level of service quality.

Education

Edinburgh Business School, Heriot-Watt University

Postgraduate Diploma in Business Administration, Business Administration and Management, General · (2015 - 2015)

Helwan University Cairo

Good, Communication and electronics · (1992 - 1996)

Ibrahimya school

Secondary School, Secondary School · (1989 - 1991)

Helwan University Cairo

Bachelor's degree, Communication and electronics Engineering · (February 1991 - February 1996)